Principles of Information Quality – Fall 2026

INFQ 7303	**Lecture Instructor:** *John R. Talburt* *jrtalburt@ualr.edu* **Teaching Assistant:** *Adeeba Tarannum* *atarannum@ualr.edu*	**Class Location & Time:** *EIT 218 and Online via live webcast.* *T-R: 1:40pm to 2:55pm* *Note: All class Sessions will be recorded for later viewing.*	**Office Hours:** *T-R from 3 pm to 4:30 pm. Students can make appointments to meet in the office or to meet via virtual meeting.*

Course Textbook

- *Journey to Data Quality*, Lee, Pipino, Funk, and Wang, MIT Press, 2006 (provided by the instructor)

Course Overview

Prerequisite: Graduate Standing. This course provides a rigorous exploration of information quality concepts, assessment, and problems in organizational information systems, databases, and data warehouses. A combination of state-of-the-art literature review and hands-on projects is used to develop knowledge and ability to meet objectives (Three credits).

Learning Objectives and Topics

Through examinations, graded homework, and laboratory exercises, students will demonstrate:

1. An understanding of the principles and the knowledge and skill that comprise the field of Information Quality
2. The historical underpinnings of Information Quality
3. Definitions of basic terminology and the concepts of Information Quality Theory and Practice such as Information Quality Assessment, Dimensions of Information Quality, Information Products, Quality Control, Quality Assurance, Total Data Quality Management, Data Monetization, Data Democratization, and Data Literacy
4. The ability to recognize the underlying causes of poor information quality and understand the role and importance of information quality in modern information systems
5. An awareness of the economic and human impacts of poor information quality
6. An introduction to the principles and practice of data governance
7. An understanding of the ISO 8000 and IS 25500 Standards for Data Quality and Supply Chain Management
8. A review of the basic descriptive and inferential statistical and probability concepts and how they are used in information quality and statistical process control
9. Hands-on experience with various information quality software tools
10. The impact of Generative AI on Data Quality Management

Course Format / Instructor Presence

The course will be conducted as a seminar. Participation counts and may include small group presentations and exercises. Students are expected to have completed all assigned preparation and readings in advance and engage in full examination and discussion of topics. The instructor may call on students for questions and comments. It is important for all assignments to be completed before class in which they are addressed and reviewed. ***Note: All course content will be delivered during the scheduled classroom sessions by the Lecture Instructor and Lab Instructor, except in cases of a relevant guest speaker.***

Attendance Expectations

Classroom attendance expectations depend upon the section in which the student is enrolled. The instructor will conduct the class on campus according to schedule in the designated classroom.

1. Students enrolled in INFQ 7303-01 are expected to attend the on-campus class in-person for face-to-face instruction. Students must comply with all university health safety guidelines in effect at the time. These might include physical distancing, hand sanitizing upon room entry, desk wipe-down, and wearing of face masks. On the 10th day of university classes, students who have not attended class will be administratively withdrawn by the instructor.
2. Students enrolled in INFQ 7303-9S1 are expected to attend all class sessions online in real time as the class is being webcast and to participate by audio, video, and chat.
3. Students enrolled in INFQ 7303-9U1 do not have any attendance requirements. They have the option to attend in-person, to attend online in real time as the class is being webcast, or to view the recordings of the class webcast offline.

Students in any section may be administratively withdrawn from a class by the instructor for non-participation such as missing 4 or more consecutive live class sessions or failing to submit 2 weeks of assignments without explanation during the semester.

Communication Expectations for Regular and Substantive Interactions

In addition to the class sessions, the instructor and graduate assistant for this course will have their weekly office hours posted in the Blackboard course shell. Course communications will be done via the Blackboard Announcements and the UALR email system. Students must use their UALR email when contacting their instructors. On weekdays, a student can expect a response to their email or phone message within twenty-four hours, and forty-eight hours on the weekends. Instructors also will initiate contact with the student, so it is essential that that the student monitor their UALR emails daily, review comments and feedback on assignments, and remain actively engaged no less than several times a week in their course(s). The student's grade in the course depends on their attentiveness to the instructions and directions given by the instructor. The student is responsible for knowing the syllabus, deadlines on assignments, school policies, and all communication from the instructors to him/her individually and to the class as a whole.

Standard Credit Hour Expectations

This course will adhere to the standard credit hour policy. For a 3-credit course, students can expect 2.5 hours per week of direct faculty instruction including in-class assessment and exams (midterms and final) and 5 hours per week of out-of-class time (e.g., studying, reading, completing assignments, working on projects, etc.).

Grading and Assessment

GRADE SCALE:	A:	[90 – 100]
	B:	[80 – 90)
	C:	[70 – 80)
	D:	[60 – 70)
	F:	below 60

ASSESSMENT:	Section 01		Sections 9S1 & 9U1	
	Mid-Term Exam	33%	Mid-Term Exam	35%
	Final Exam	33%	Final Exam	35%
	Homework Exercises	15%	Homework Exercises	15%
	Lab Exercises	15%	Lab Exercises	15%
	Attendance	4%	Attendance	0%
		100%		100%

Late Assignment Submission Policy

Unless otherwise specified in class, assignments will be given through Blackboard and will be due on the day and at the time (due date) given in the Blackboard assignment. All Blackboard assignments have a due date and a closing day and time (closing date). Typically, the due date is the start of a scheduled class meeting, and the closing date is the beginning of the next consecutive class meeting. Assignments submitted after the due date and before the closing date will be accepted but will incur a penalty of 20%. After the assignment closing date, submissions will not be accepted, and the student will not receive credit for the assignment.

Mid-Term and Final Examination Policy

1. Students enrolled in Sections 01 and 9S1 are expected to take the mid-term and final examinations in-person at the designated time and location on campus.
2. Students enrolled in Section 9U1 will take the mid-term and final examination online using the Lockdown Browser and Respondus Monitoring System during a designated window of time around the date of the on-campus exam.

Inclement Weather Policy

During inclement weather, UA Little Rock will make a decision whether or not to close based on all available information. The chancellor will decide whether or not conditions warrant canceling classes and activities and closing the campus or whether classes and activities will be canceled but with specified campus offices open. Online or web-enhanced classes will continue as scheduled at the discretion of the faculty member. The UA Little Rock website, UA Little Rock email, the university's main telephone number (501.569.3000), and the Rave campus alert notification system are the official means of communicating information concerning weather-related closings. When necessary, the university will announce a separate decision about canceling night classes (those classes starting at 4:20 p.m. or later) by 2 p.m., if possible. For further information, review the Inclement Weather Policy available at https://ualr.edu/policy/home/admin/weather/.

UA Little Rock Policies on Disability, Academic Integrity, and Student Services

Links to these policies and services can be found on the Content Page of the Blackboard Ultra Couse Shell.